

Multi-period planning

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1 Planning problems

- Planning future activities
- Decide the values of planning variables, like workforce, capacities, production etc. for the future
- The future is divided into a number of discrete time periods, within a given time planning horizon

1.1 Link between periods

Normally, the time periods (days, weeks, months) are linked in some way:

- in production / supply chain planning:

$$\text{inventory}(t) = \text{inventory}(t - 1) + \text{production}(t) - \text{demand}(t)$$

- in manpower planning:

$$\text{workforce}(t) = \text{workforce}(t - 1) + \text{people hired}(t) - \text{people fired}(t)$$

- In financial planning:

$$\text{cash balance}(t) = \text{cash balance}(t - 1) + \text{incoming cash flow}(t) - \text{payments}(t)$$

2 Example

- 1 product
- 3 periods

	period 1	period 2	period 3
demand	4	9	14
initial inventory	3	0	0
production capacity	10	10	10
production cost	4	7	8
inventory cost	2	2	2

- Optimization problem:
 - Minimize total costs = sum production costs + sum inventory costs
 - s.t. production must be less than or equal to production capacity in each period, inventory balance constraint, production and inventory must be non-negative in each period
- variables:
 - X_t : production quantity in period t
 - I_t : inventory by the end of period t
- Parameters:
 -
 - c_t : production cost in period t
 - i_t : inventory cost in period t
 - cap_t : production capacity for period t
 - d_t : demand for period t
 - init : initial inventory
- model

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \min \sum_t c_t X_t + i_t I_t \\
 & \text{s.t.} \\
 & X_t \leq \text{cap}_t \quad \forall t \\
 & I_t = I_{t-1} + X_t - d_t \quad \forall t \geq 2 \\
 & I_1 = \text{init} + X_1 - d_1 \\
 & X_t, I_t \geq 0 \quad \forall t
 \end{aligned}$$

3 Example extension: multiple products

Parameters:

- $c_{p,t}$: production cost for product p in time period t
- $i_{p,t}$: inventory holding cost for product p in time period t
- cap_t : production capacity for period t
- $d_{p,t}$: demand for product p in time period t
- init_p : initial inventory for product p

Variables:

- $X_{p,t}$: production quantity for product p in period t
- $I_{p,t}$: inventory for product p in period t

Model:

$$\begin{aligned} \min \quad & \sum_p \sum_t c_{p,t} X_{p,t} + i_{p,t} I_{p,t} \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & \sum_p X_{p,t} \leq \text{cap}_t \quad \forall t \\ & I_{p,t} = I_{p,t-1} + X_{p,t} - d_{p,t} \quad \forall p \quad \forall t \geq 2 \\ & I_{p,1} = \text{init}_p + X_{p,1} - d_{p,1} \quad \forall p \\ & X_{p,t}, I_{p,t} \geq 0 \quad \forall p, t \end{aligned}$$

4 Basic production planning, one customer

Parameters:

- pc_t : production cost per unit produced in period t
- sc_t : storage cost for storing per unit in inventory by the end of period t
- cap_t : production capacity in period t
- d_t : demand in period t

Variables:

- X_t : production quantity in period t
- I_t : inventory by the end of period t

Model:

$$\begin{aligned} \min \quad & \sum_t pc_t X_t + sc_t I_t \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & X_t \leq cap_t \quad \forall t \\ & I_t = I_{t-1} + X_t - d_t \quad \forall t \geq 2 \\ & I_1 = X_1 - d_1 \\ & X_t, I_t \geq 0 \quad \forall t \end{aligned}$$

5 Basic production planning, one factory

Parameters:

- pc_t : production cost per unit produced in period t
- sc_t : storage cost for storing per unit in inventory by the end of period t
- cap_t : production capacity in period t
- $d_{k,t}$: demand for customer k in period t

Variables:

- X_t : production quantity in period t
- I_t : inventory by the end of period t

Model:

$$\begin{aligned} \min \quad & \sum_t pc_t X_t + sc_t I_t \\ \text{s.t.} \quad & X_t \leq cap_t \quad \forall t \\ & I_t = I_{t-1} + X_t - \sum_k d_{k,t} \quad \forall t \\ & X_t, I_t \geq 0 \quad \forall t \end{aligned}$$

6 Production planning, coordination of multiple factories i

Parameters:

- $pc_{i,t}$: production cost per unit produced in period t
- $sc_{i,t}$: storage cost for storing per unit in inventory at i by the end of period t
- $tc_{i,k,t}$: transportation cost per unit from i to k in period t
- $cap_{i,t}$: production capacity at factory i in period t
- $d_{k,t}$: demand for customer k in period t

Variables:

- $X_{i,t}$: production quantity at factory i in period t
- $I_{i,t}$: inventory at factory i in period t
- $Z_{i,k,t}$: transported quantity from i to k in period t

Model:

$$\begin{aligned}
 \min \quad & \sum_i \sum_t pc_{i,t} X_{i,t} + sc_{i,t} I_{i,t} + \sum_i \sum_t \sum_k tc_{i,k,t} Z_{i,k,t} \\
 \text{s.t.} \quad & X_{i,t} \leq cap_{i,t} \quad \forall i, t \\
 & I_{i,t} = I_{i,t-1} + X_{i,t} - \sum_k Z_{i,k,t} \quad \forall i, t \\
 & \sum_i Z_{i,k,t} = d_{k,t} \quad \forall k, t
 \end{aligned}$$

7 Economies of scale

- Economies of scale of the order of quantity is a very common phenomenon
- In a production process, there is normally some loss of efficiency when switching between products, i.e., we would like to maximize the lot size when we produce a given product.
- Also in transportation, there is normally economies of scale. Driving a dairy truck a given distance has the same cost regardless of how many bottles of milk there are in the back. That is, a full truck will have a lower cost per bottle
- In purchasing, the economies of scale is often represented by a given cost